

On Baptism

Tertullian

Translated by S. Thelwall.

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On Baptism.

Introduction. Origin of the Treatise.

II.

[Translated by the Rev. S. Thelwall.]

Chapter I.—Introduction. Origin of the Treatise.

HAPPY is our¹ sacrament of water, in that, by washing away the sins of our early blindness, we are set free *and admitted* into eternal life! A treatise on this matter will not be superfluous; instructing not only such as are just becoming formed (in the faith), but them who, content with having simply believed, without full examination of the grounds² of the traditions, carry (in mind), through ignorance, an untried *though* probable faith. The consequence is, that a viper of the Cainite heresy, lately conversant in this quarter, has carried away a great number with her most venomous doctrine, making it her first aim to destroy baptism. Which is quite in accordance with nature; for vipers and asps and basilisks themselves generally do affect arid and waterless places. But we, little fishes, after the example of our ΙΧΘΥΣ³ Jesus Christ, are born in water, nor have we safety in any other way than by permanently abiding in water; so that most monstrous creature, who had no right to teach even sound doctrine,⁴ knew full well how to kill the little fishes, by taking them away from the water!

The Very Simplicity of God's Means of Working, a Stumbling-Block to the Carnal Mind.

Chapter II.—The Very Simplicity of God's Means of Working, a Stumbling-Block to the Carnal Mind.

Well, but how great is the force of perversity for *so* shaking the faith or entirely preventing its reception, that it impugns it on the very principles of which *the faith* consists! There is absolutely nothing which makes men's minds more obdurate than the simplicity of the divine works which are visible in the *act*, when compared with the grandeur which is promised thereto in the *effect*; so that from the very fact, that with so great simplicity, without pomp, without any considerable novelty of preparation, finally, without expense, a man is dipped in water, and amid the utterance of some few words, is sprinkled, and then rises again, not much (or not at all) the cleaner, the consequent attainment of eternity⁵ is esteemed the more incredible. I am a deceiver if, on the contrary, it is not from their circumstance, and preparation, and expense, that *idols'* solemnities or mysteries get their credit and authority built up. Oh, miserable incredulity, which quite deniest to God His own properties, simplicity and power! What then? Is it not wonderful, too, that death should be washed away by bathing? But it is the more to be believed if the wonderfulness be the reason why it is *not* believed. For what does it behove divine works to be in their quality, except

¹i.e. Christian (Oehler).

²Rationibus.

³This curious allusion it is impossible, perhaps, to render in our language. The word ΙΧΘΥΣ (*ikththus*) in Greek means "a fish;" and it was used as a name for our Lord Jesus, because the initials of the words Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς Θεοῦ Υἱὸς Σωτήρ (i.e. Jesus Christ the Son of God, the Savior), make up that word. OEHLER with these remarks, gives abundant references on that point. [Dr. Allix suspects Montanism here, but see Kaye, p. 43, and Lardner, *Credib.* II. p. 335. We may date it *circa* A.D. 193.]

⁴As being a woman. See 1 Tim. ii. 11, 12.

⁵Consecutio æternitatis.

that they be above all wonder?⁶ We also ourselves wonder, but it is *because* we believe. Incredulity, on the other hand, wonders, but does *not* believe: for the simple *acts* it wonders at, as if they were vain; the grand *results*, as if they were impossible. And grant that it be just as you think⁷ sufficient to meet each point is the divine declaration which has forerun: “The foolish things of the world hath God elected to confound its wisdom;”⁸ and, “The things very difficult with men are easy with God.”⁹ For if God is wise and powerful (which even they who pass Him by do not deny), it is with good reason that He lays the material causes of His own operation in the contraries of wisdom and of power, that is, in foolishness and impossibility; since every virtue receives its cause from those things by which it is called forth.

Water Chosen as a Vehicle of Divine Operation and Wherefore. Its Prominence First of All in Creation.

Chapter III.—Water Chosen as a Vehicle of Divine Operation and Wherefore. Its Prominence First of All in Creation.

Mindful of this declaration as of a conclusive prescript, we nevertheless *proceed* to treat the question, “How foolish and impossible it is to be formed anew by water. In what respect, pray, has this material substance merited an office of so high dignity?” The authority, I suppose, of the liquid element has to be examined.¹⁰ This¹¹ however, is found in abundance, and that from the very beginning. For *water* is one of those things which, before all the furnishing of the world, were quiescent with God in a yet unshapen¹² state. “In the first beginning,” saith *Scripture*, “God made the heaven and the earth. But the earth was invisible, and unorganized,¹³ and darkness was over the abyss; and the Spirit of the Lord was hovering¹⁴ over the waters.”¹⁵ The first thing, O man, which you have to venerate, is the *age* of the waters in that their substance is ancient; the second, their *dignity*, in that they were the seat of the Divine Spirit, more pleasing to *Him*, no doubt, than all the other then existing elements. For the darkness was total thus far, shapeless, without the ornament of stars; and the abyss gloomy; and the earth unfurnished; and the heaven unwrought: water¹⁶ alone—always a perfect, gladsome, simple material substance, pure in itself—supplied a worthy vehicle to God. What of the *fact* that waters were in some way the regulating powers by which the disposition of the world thenceforward was constituted by God? For the suspension of the celestial firmament in the midst He caused by “dividing the waters;”¹⁷ the suspension of “the dry land” He accomplished by “separating the waters.” After the world had been hereupon set in order through *its* elements, when inhabitants were given it, “the waters” were the first to receive the precept “to bring forth living creatures.”¹⁸ Water was the first to produce that which

⁶Admirationem.

⁷i.e. that the simple be vain, and the grand impossible.

⁸1 Cor. i. 27, not quite exactly quoted.

⁹Luke xviii. 27, again inexact.

¹⁰Compare the Jews’ question, Matt. xxi. 23.

¹¹Its authority.

¹²Impolita.

¹³Incomposita.

¹⁴Ferebatur.

¹⁵Gen. i. 1, 2, and comp. the LXX.

¹⁶Liquor.

¹⁷Gen. i. 6, 7, 8.

¹⁸Animas.

had life, that it might be no wonder in baptism if waters know how to give life.¹⁹ For was not the work of fashioning man himself also achieved with the aid of waters? Suitable material is found in the *earth*, yet not apt for the purpose unless it be moist and juicy; which (earth) “the waters,” separated the fourth day before into their own place, temper with their remaining moisture to a clayey consistency. If, from that time onward, I go forward in recounting universally, or at more length, the evidences of the “authority” of this element which I can adduce to show how great is its power or its grace; how many ingenious devices, how many functions, how useful an instrumentality, it affords the world, I fear I may seem to have collected rather the praises of water than the reasons of baptism; although I should *thereby* teach all the more fully, that it is not to be doubted that God has made the material substance which He has disposed throughout all His products²⁰ and works, obey Him also in His own peculiar sacraments; that the *material substance* which governs terrestrial life acts as agent likewise in the celestial.

The Primeval Hovering of the Spirit of God Over the Waters Typical of Baptism. The Universal Element of Water Thus Made a Channel of Sanctification. Resemblance Between the Outward Sign and the Inward Grace.

Chapter IV.—The Primeval Hovering of the Spirit of God Over the Waters Typical of Baptism. The Universal Element of Water Thus Made a Channel of Sanctification. Resemblance Between the Outward Sign and the Inward Grace.

But it will suffice to have *thus* called at the outset those points in which withal is recognised that primary principle of baptism,—which was even then fore-noted by the very attitude *assumed* for a type of baptism,—that the Spirit of God, who hovered over (the waters) from the beginning, would continue to linger over the waters of the baptized.²¹ But a holy thing, of course, hovered over a holy; or else, from that which hovered over that which *was* hovered over borrowed a holiness, since it is necessary that in every case an underlying material substance should catch the quality of that which overhangs it, most of all a corporeal of a spiritual, adapted (as the spiritual is) through the subtleness of its substance, both for penetrating and insinuating. Thus the nature of the waters, sanctified by the Holy One, itself conceived withal the power of sanctifying. Let no one say, “Why then, are we, pray, baptized with the very waters which then existed in the first beginning?” Not with those waters, of course, except in so far as the *genus* indeed is one, but the *species* very many. But what is an attribute to the *genus* reappears²² likewise in the *species*. And accordingly it makes no difference whether a man be washed in a sea or a pool, a stream or a fount, a lake or a trough;²³ nor is there any distinction between those whom John baptized in the Jordan and those whom Peter baptized in the Tiber, unless withal the eunuch whom Philip baptized in the midst of his journeys with chance water, derived (therefrom) more or less of salvation *than others*.²⁴ All waters, therefore, in virtue of the pristine privilege of their origin, do, after invocation of God, attain the sacramental power of sanctification; for the Spirit immediately supervenes from the heavens, and rests over the waters, sanctifying them from Himself; and being thus sanctified, they imbibe at the same time the power of sanctifying. Albeit the similitude may be admitted to be suitable to the simple act;

¹⁹ Animare.

²⁰ Rebus.

²¹ Intinctorum.

²² Redundat.

²³ Alveo.

²⁴ Acts viii. 26–40.

that, since we are defiled by sins, as it were by dirt, we should be washed from those stains in waters. But as sins do not show themselves in our *flesh* (inasmuch as no one carries on his skin the spot of idolatry, or fornication, or fraud), so persons of that kind are foul in the *spirit*, which is the author of the sin; for the spirit is lord, the flesh servant. Yet they each mutually share the guilt: the spirit, on the ground of command; the flesh, of subservience. Therefore, after the waters have been in a manner endued with medicinal virtue²⁵ through the intervention of the angel,²⁶ the spirit is corporeally washed in the waters, and the flesh is in the same spiritually cleansed.

Use Made of Water by the Heathen. Type of the Angel at the Pool of Bethsaida.

Chapter V.—Use Made of Water by the Heathen. Type of the Angel at the Pool of Bethsaida.²⁷

“Well, but the nations, who are strangers to all understanding of spiritual powers, ascribe to their idols the imbuing of waters with the self-same efficacy.” (So they do) but they cheat themselves with waters which are widowed.²⁸ For washing is the channel through which they are initiated into some sacred rites—of some notorious Isis or Mithras. The gods themselves likewise they honour by washings. Moreover, by carrying water around, and sprinkling it, they everywhere expiate²⁹ country-seats, houses, temples, and whole cities: at all events, at the Apollinarian and Eleusinian games they are baptized; and they presume that the effect of their doing that is their regeneration and the remission of the penalties due to their perjuries. Among the ancients, again, whoever had defiled himself with murder, was wont to go in quest of purifying waters. Therefore, if the mere nature of water, in that it is the appropriate material for washing away, leads men to flatter themselves with a belief in omens of purification, how much more truly will waters render that service through the authority of God, by whom all their nature has been constituted! If men think that water is endued with a medicinal virtue by religion, what religion is more effectual than that of the living God? Which fact being acknowledged, we recognise here also the zeal of the devil rivalling the things of God,³⁰ while we find him, too, practising baptism in his *subjects*. What similarity is there? The unclean cleanses! the ruiner sets free! the damned absolves! He will, forsooth, destroy his own work, by washing away the sins which himself inspires! These (remarks) have been set down by way of testimony against such as reject the faith; if they put no trust in the things of God, the spurious imitations of which, in the case of God’s rival, they do trust in. Are there not other cases too, in which, without any sacrament, unclean spirits brood on waters, in spurious imitation of that brooding³¹ of the Divine Spirit in the very beginning? Witness all shady founts, and all unfrequented brooks, and the ponds in the baths, and the conduits³² in *private* houses, or the cisterns and wells which are said to have the property of “spiriting away,”³³ through the power, that is, of a hurtful spirit. Men whom waters have drowned³⁴ or affected with madness or with fear, they call nymph-caught,³⁵ or “lymphatic,” or “hydro-phobic.” Why have we adduced

²⁵Medicatis.

²⁶See c. vi. *ad init.*, and c. v. *ad fin.*

²⁷Bethesda, Eng. Ver.

²⁸i.e., as Oehler rightly explains, “lacking the Holy Spirit’s presence and virtue.”

²⁹Or, “purify.”

³⁰[Diabolus Dei Simius.]

³¹Gestationem.

³²Euripi.

³³Rapere.

³⁴Necaverunt.

³⁵“Nympholeptos,” restored by Oehler, = νυμφολήπτους.

these instances? Lest any think it too hard *for belief* that a holy angel of God should grant his presence to waters, to temper them to man's salvation; while the evil angel holds frequent profane commerce with the selfsame element to man's ruin. If it seems a novelty for an angel to be present in waters, an example of what was to come to pass has forerun. An angel, by his intervention, was wont to stir the pool at Bethesda.³⁶ They who were complaining of ill-health used to watch for him; for whoever had been the first to descend into them, after his washing, ceased to complain. This figure of corporeal healing sang of a spiritual healing, according to the rule by which things carnal are always antecedent³⁷ as figurative of things spiritual. And thus, when the grace of God advanced to higher degrees among men,³⁸ an accession of *efficacy* was granted to the waters and to the angel. They who³⁹ were wont to remedy bodily defects,⁴⁰ now heal the spirit; they who used to work temporal salvation⁴¹ now renew eternal; they who did set free but once in the year, now save peoples in a body⁴² daily, death being done away through ablution of sins. The guilt being removed, of course the penalty is removed too. Thus man will be restored for God to His "likeness," who in days bygone had been *conformed* to "the image" of God; (the "image" is counted (to be) in his *form*: the "likeness" in his *eternity*;) for he receives again that Spirit of God which he had then first received from His *afflatus*, but had afterward lost through sin.

The Angel the Forerunner of the Holy Spirit. Meaning Contained in the Baptismal Formula.

Chapter VI.—The Angel the Forerunner of the Holy Spirit. Meaning Contained in the Baptismal Formula.

Not that *in*⁴³ the waters we obtain the Holy Spirit; but in the water, under (the witness of) the angel, we are cleansed, and prepared *for* the Holy Spirit. In this case also a type has preceded; for thus was John beforehand the Lord's forerunner, "preparing His ways."⁴⁴ Thus, too, does the angel, the witness⁴⁵ of baptism, "make the paths straight"⁴⁶ for the Holy Spirit, who is about to come upon us, by the washing away of sins, which faith, sealed in (the name of) the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, obtains. For if "in the mouth of three witnesses every word shall stand:"⁴⁷—while, through the benediction, we have the same (three) as witnesses of our faith whom we have as sureties⁴⁸ of our salvation too—how much more does the number of the divine names suffice for the assurance of our hope likewise! Moreover, after the pledging both of the attestation of faith and the promise⁴⁹ of salvation under "three witnesses," there is added, of necessity, mention of the

³⁶So Tertullian reads, and some copies, but not the best, of the New Testament in the place referred to, John v. 1–9. [And note Tertullian's textual testimony as to this Scripture.]

³⁷Compare 1 Cor. xv. 46.

³⁸John i. 16, 17.

³⁹Qui: i.e. probably "angeli qui."

⁴⁰Vitia.

⁴¹Or, "health"—salutem.

⁴²Conservant populos.

⁴³Compare c. viii., where Tertullian appears to regard the Holy Spirit as given *after* the baptized had come out of the waters and received the "unction."

⁴⁴Luke i. 76.

⁴⁵Arbiter. [Eccles. v. 6, and Acts xii. 15.]

⁴⁶Isa. xl. 3; Matt. iii. 3.

⁴⁷Deut. xix. 15; Matt. xviii. 16; 2 Cor. xiii. 1.

⁴⁸Sponsores.

⁴⁹Sponsio.

Church;⁵⁰ inasmuch as, wherever there are three, (that is, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit,) there is the Church, which is a body of three.⁵¹

Of the Unction.

Chapter VII.—Of the Unction.

After this, when we have issued from the font,⁵² we are thoroughly anointed with a blessed unction,—(a practice derived) from the old discipline, wherein on entering the priesthood, *men* were wont to be anointed with oil from a horn, ever since Aaron was anointed by Moses.⁵³ Whence Aaron is called “Christ,”⁵⁴ from the “chrism,” which is “the unction;” which, when made spiritual, furnished an appropriate name to the Lord, because He was “anointed” with the Spirit by God the Father; as *written* in the Acts: “For truly they were gathered together in this city⁵⁵ against Thy Holy Son whom Thou hast anointed.”⁵⁶ Thus, too, in *our* case, the unction runs carnally, (*i.e.* on the body,) but profits spiritually; in the same way as the *act* of baptism itself too is carnal, in that we are plunged in water, *but* the *effect* spiritual, in that we are freed from sins.

Of the Imposition of Hands. Types of the Deluge and the Dove.

Chapter VIII.—Of the Imposition of Hands. Types of the Deluge and the Dove.

In the next place the hand is laid on us, invoking and inviting the Holy Spirit through benediction.⁵⁷ Shall it be granted possible for human ingenuity to summon a spirit into water, and, by the application of hands from above, to animate their union into one body⁵⁸ with another spirit of so clear sound;⁵⁹ and shall it not be possible for God, in the case of His own organ,⁶⁰ to produce, by means of “holy hands,”⁶¹ a sublime spiritual modulation? But this, as well as the former, is derived from the old sacramental rite in which Jacob blessed his grandsons, born of Joseph, Ephrem⁶² and Manasses; with his hands laid on them and interchanged, and indeed so transversely slanted one over the other, that, by delineating Christ, they even portended the future benediction into Christ.⁶³ Then, over our cleansed and blessed bodies willingly descends from the Father that Holiest Spirit. Over the waters of baptism, recognising as it were His primeval seat,⁶⁴ He reposes: (He who) glided down on the Lord “in the shape of a dove,”⁶⁵ in order that the nature of the Holy Spirit might be declared by means of the creature (the emblem) of simplicity and innocence, because even

⁵⁰Compare *de Orat.* c. ii. *sub fin.*

⁵¹Compare the *de Orat.* quoted above, and *de Patien.* xxi.; and see Matt. xviii. 20.

⁵²Lavacro.

⁵³See Ex. xxix. 7; Lev. viii. 12; Ps. cxxxiii. 2.

⁵⁴*i.e.* “Anointed.” Aaron, or at least the priest, is actually so called in the LXX., in Lev. iv. 5, 16, ὁ ἱερεὺς ὁ Χριστός: as in the Hebrew it is the word whence *Messiah* is derived which is used.

⁵⁵Civitate.

⁵⁶Acts iv. 27. “In this city” (ἐν τῇ πόλει ταύτῃ) is omitted in the English version; and the name Ἰησοῦν, “Jesus,” is omitted by Tertullian. Compare Acts x. 38 and Lev. iv. 18 with Isa. lxi. 1 in the LXX.

⁵⁷[See Bunsen, *Hippol.* Vol. III. Sec. xiii. p. 22.]

⁵⁸Concorporationem.

⁵⁹The reference is to certain hydraulic organs, which the editors tell us are described by Vitruvius, ix. 9 and x. 13, and Pliny, *H. N.* vii. 37.

⁶⁰*i.e.* Man. There may be an allusion to Eph. ii. 10, “We are His workmanship,” and to Ps. cl. 4.

⁶¹Compare 1 Tim. ii. 8.

⁶²*i.e.* Ephraim.

⁶³In Christum.

⁶⁴See c. iv. p. 668.

⁶⁵Matt. iii. 16; Luke iii. 22.

in her bodily structure the dove is without literal⁶⁶ gall. And accordingly He says, “Be ye simple as doves.”⁶⁷ Even this is not without the supporting evidence⁶⁸ of a preceding figure. For just as, after the waters of the deluge, by which the old iniquity was purged—after the baptism, so to say, of the world—a *dove* was the herald which announced to the earth the assuagement⁶⁹ of celestial wrath, when she had been sent her way out of the ark, and had returned with the olive-branch, a sign which even among the nations is the fore-token of *peace*;⁷⁰ so by the self-same law⁷¹ of heavenly effect, to earth—that is, to our flesh⁷²—as it emerges from the font,⁷³ after its old sins flies the *dove* of the Holy Spirit, bringing us the peace of God, sent out from the heavens where is the Church, the typified ark.⁷⁴ But the world returned unto sin; in which point baptism would ill be compared to the deluge. And so it is destined to fire; just as the man too is, who after baptism renews his sins.⁷⁵ so that this also ought to be accepted as a sign for our admonition.

Types of the Red Sea, and the Water from the Rock.

Chapter IX.—Types of the Red Sea, and the Water from the Rock.

How many, therefore, are the pleas⁷⁶ of nature, how many the privileges of grace, how many the solemnities of discipline, the figures, the preparations, the prayers, which have ordained the sanctity of water? First, indeed, when the people, set unconditionally free,⁷⁷ escaped the violence of the Egyptian king by crossing over *through water*, it was *water* that extinguished⁷⁸ the king himself, with his entire forces.⁷⁹ What figure more manifestly fulfilled in the sacrament of baptism? The nations are set free from the world⁸⁰ by means of *water*, to wit: and the devil, their old tyrant, they leave quite behind, overwhelmed in the *water*. Again, *water* is restored from its defect of “bitterness” to its native grace of “sweetness” by the tree⁸¹ of Moses. That tree was Christ,⁸² restoring, to wit, of Himself, the *veins* of sometime envenomed and bitter nature into the all-salutary *waters* of baptism. This is the *water* which flowed continuously down for the people from the “accompanying rock;” for if Christ is “the Rock,” without doubt we see baptism blest by the *water* in Christ. How mighty is the grace of *water*, in the sight of God and His Christ, for the confirmation of baptism! Never is Christ without *water*: if, that is, He is Himself baptized in *water*;⁸³ inaugurates in *water* the first

⁶⁶Ipsa. The ancients held this.

⁶⁷Matt. x. 16. Tertullian has rendered ἀκέρατοι (*unmixed*) by “simplices,” i.e. without fold.

⁶⁸Argumento.

⁶⁹Pacem.

⁷⁰Paci.

⁷¹Dispositione.

⁷²See *de Orat.* iv. *ad init.*

⁷³Lavacro.

⁷⁴Compare *de Idol.* xxiv. *ad fin.*

⁷⁵[2 Pet. i. 9; Heb. x. 26, 27, 29. These awful texts are too little felt by modern Christians. They are too often explained away.]

⁷⁶Patrocinia—“pleas in defence.”

⁷⁷“Libere expeditus,” set free, and that without any conditions, such as Pharaoh had from time to time tried to impose. See Ex. viii. 25, 28; x. 10, 11, 24.

⁷⁸“Extinxit,” as it does *fire*.

⁷⁹Ex. xiv. 27–30.

⁸⁰Sæculo.

⁸¹See Ex. xv. 24, 25.

⁸²“The Tree of Life,” “the True Vine,” etc.

⁸³Matt. iii. 13–17.

rudimentary displays of His power, when invited to the nuptials;⁸⁴ invites the thirsty, when He makes a discourse, to His own sempiternal *water*;⁸⁵ approves, when teaching concerning love,⁸⁶ among works of charity,⁸⁷ the cup of *water* offered to a poor (child);⁸⁸ recruits His strength at a *well*;⁸⁹ walks over the *water*;⁹⁰ willingly crosses the *sea*;⁹¹ ministers *water* to His disciples.⁹² Onward even to the passion does the witness of baptism last: while He is being surrendered to the cross, *water* intervenes; witness Pilate's hands:⁹³ when He is wounded, forth from His side bursts *water*; witness the soldier's lance!⁹⁴

Of John's Baptism.

Chapter X.—Of John's Baptism.

We have spoken, so far as our moderate ability permitted, of the *generals* which form the groundwork of the sanctity⁹⁵ of baptism. I will now, equally to the best of my power, proceed to the rest of its character, touching certain minor questions.

The baptism announced by John formed the subject, even at that time, of a question, proposed by the Lord Himself indeed to the Pharisees, whether that baptism were heavenly, or truly earthly:⁹⁶ about which they were unable to give a consistent⁹⁷ answer, inasmuch as they understood not, because they believed not. But *we*, with but as poor a measure of understanding as of faith, *are* able to determine that that baptism was *divine* indeed, (yet in respect of the command, not in respect of efficacy⁹⁸ too, in that we read that John was *sent by the Lord* to perform this duty,)⁹⁹ but *human* in its nature: for it conveyed nothing celestial, but it fore-ministered to things celestial; being, to wit, appointed over *repentance*, which is in man's power.¹⁰⁰ In fact, the doctors of the law and the Pharisees, who were unwilling to "believe," did not "repent" either.¹⁰¹ But if repentance is a thing human, its baptism must necessarily be of the same nature: else, if it had been celestial, it would have given both the Holy Spirit and remission of sins. But none either pardons sins or freely grants the Spirit save God only.¹⁰² Even the Lord Himself said that the Spirit would not descend on any other condition, but that He should first ascend to the Father.¹⁰³ What the Lord was not yet conferring, of course the servant could not furnish. Accordingly, in the Acts of the

⁸⁴John ii. 1–11.

⁸⁵John vii. 37, 38.

⁸⁶Agape. See *de Orat.* c. 28, *ad fin.*

⁸⁷Dilectionis. See *de Patien.* c. xii.

⁸⁸Matt. x. 42.

⁸⁹John iv. 6.

⁹⁰Matt. xiv. 25.

⁹¹Mark iv. 36.

⁹²John xiii. 1–12.

⁹³Matt. xxvii. 24. Comp. *de Orat.* c. xiii.

⁹⁴John xix. 34. See c. xviii. *sub fin.*

⁹⁵Religionem.

⁹⁶Matt. xxi. 25; Mark xi. 30; Luke xx. 4.

⁹⁷Constanter.

⁹⁸Potestate.

⁹⁹See John i. 33.

¹⁰⁰It is difficult to see how this statement is to be reconciled with Acts v. 31. [i.e. under the universal illumination, John i. 9.]

¹⁰¹Matt. iii. 7–12; xxi. 23, 31, 32.

¹⁰²Mark ii. 8; 1 Thess. iv. 8; 2 Cor. i. 21, 22; v. 5.

¹⁰³John xvi. 6, 7.

Apostles, we find that men who had “John’s baptism” had not received the Holy Spirit, whom they knew not even by hearing.¹⁰⁴ That, then, was no celestial thing which furnished no celestial (endowments): whereas the very thing which *was* celestial in John—the Spirit of prophecy—so completely failed, after the transfer of the whole Spirit to the Lord, that he presently sent to inquire whether He whom he had himself preached,¹⁰⁵ whom he had pointed out when coming to him, were “HE.”¹⁰⁶ And so “the baptism of repentance”¹⁰⁷ was dealt with¹⁰⁸ as if it were a candidate for the remission and sanctification shortly about to follow in Christ: for in that John used to preach “baptism *for* the remission of sins,”¹⁰⁹ the declaration was made with reference to *future* remission; if it be true, (as it is,) that repentance is antecedent, remission subsequent; and this is “preparing the way.”¹¹⁰ But he who “prepares” does not himself “perfect,” but procures for another to perfect. John himself professes that the celestial things are not his, but Christ’s, by saying, “He who is from the earth speaketh concerning the earth; He who comes from the *realms* above is above all;”¹¹¹ and again, by saying that he “baptized in repentance only, but that One would shortly come who would baptize in the Spirit and fire;”¹¹²—of course because true and stable faith is baptized with *water*, unto salvation; pretended and weak faith is baptized with *fire*, unto judgment.

Answer to the Objection that “The Lord Did Not Baptize.”

Chapter XI.—Answer to the Objection that “The Lord Did Not Baptize.”

“But behold, “say some, “the Lord came, and baptized not; for we read, ‘And yet He used not to baptize, but His disciples!’”¹¹³ As if, in truth, John had preached that He would baptize with His own hands! Of course, his words are not so to be understood, but as simply spoken after an ordinary manner; just as, for instance, we say, “The emperor set forth an edict,” or, “The prefect cudgelled him.” Pray does the emperor in person set forth, or the prefect in person cudgel? One whose ministers do a thing is always said to do it.¹¹⁴ So “He will baptize you” will have to be understood as standing for, “Through Him,” or “Into Him,” “you will be baptized.” But let not (the fact) that “He Himself baptized not” trouble any. For into whom should He baptize? Into repentance? Of what use, then, do you make His forerunner? Into remission of sins, which He used to give by a word? Into Himself, whom by humility He was concealing? Into the Holy Spirit, who had not yet descended from the Father? Into the Church, which His apostles had not yet founded? And thus it was with the selfsame “baptism of John” that His disciples used to baptize, as ministers, with which John before had baptized as forerunner. Let none think it was with some other, because no other exists, except that of Christ subsequently; which at that time, of course, could not be given by His disciples, inasmuch as the glory of the Lord had not yet been fully attained,¹¹⁵ nor the efficacy of the font¹¹⁶ established through the passion and the resurrection; because neither

¹⁰⁴Acts xix. 1–7. [John vii. 39.]

¹⁰⁵Matt. iii. 11, 12; John i. 6–36.

¹⁰⁶Matt. xi. 2–6; Luke vii. 18–23. [He repeats this view.]

¹⁰⁷Acts xix. 4.

¹⁰⁸Agebatur.

¹⁰⁹Mark i. 4.

¹¹⁰Luke i. 76.

¹¹¹John iii. 30, 31, briefly quoted.

¹¹²Matt. iii. 11, not quite exactly given.

¹¹³John iv. 2.

¹¹⁴For instances of this, compare Matt. viii. 5 with Luke vii. 3, 7; and Mark x. 35 with Matt. xx. 20.

¹¹⁵Cf. 1 Pet. i. 11, *ad fin.*

¹¹⁶Lavacri.

can our death see dissolution except by the Lord's passion, nor our life be restored without His resurrection.

Of the Necessity of Baptism to Salvation.

Chapter XII.—Of the Necessity of Baptism to Salvation.

When, however, the prescript is laid down that “without baptism, salvation is attainable by none” (chiefly on the ground of that declaration of the Lord, who says, “Unless one be born of water, he hath not life”¹¹⁷), there arise immediately scrupulous, nay rather audacious, doubts on the part of some, “how, in accordance with that prescript, salvation is attainable by the apostles, whom—Paul excepted—we do not find baptized in the Lord? Nay, since Paul is the only one of them who has put on *the garment of Christ's baptism*,¹¹⁸ either the peril of all the others who lack the water of Christ is prejudged, that the prescript may be maintained, or else the prescript is rescinded if salvation has been ordained even for the unbaptized.” I have heard—the Lord is my witness—doubts of that kind: that none may imagine me so abandoned as to excogitate, unprovoked, in the licence of my pen, ideas which would inspire others with scruple.

And now, as far as I shall be able, I will reply to them who affirm “that the apostles were unbaptized.” For if they had undergone the human baptism of John, and were longing for that of the Lord, *then* since the Lord Himself had defined baptism to be *one*,¹¹⁹ (saying to Peter, who was desirous¹²⁰ of being thoroughly bathed, “He who hath once bathed hath no necessity *to wash* a second time;”¹²¹ which, of course, He would not have said at all to one *not* baptized;) even here we have a conspicuous¹²² proof against those who, in order to destroy the sacrament of water, deprive the apostles even of John's baptism. Can it seem credible that “the way of the Lord,” that is, the baptism of John, had not then been “prepared” in those persons who were being destined to *open* the way of the Lord throughout the whole world? The Lord Himself, though no “repentance” was due from *Him*, was baptized: was baptism not necessary for *sinners*? As for the fact, then, that “others were not baptized”—they, however, were not companions of Christ, but enemies of the faith, doctors of the law and Pharisees. From which fact is gathered an additional suggestion, that, since the *opposers* of the Lord *refused* to be baptized, they who *followed* the Lord *were* baptized, and were not like-minded with their own rivals: especially when, if there were any one to whom they clave, the Lord had exalted John above him (by the testimony) saying, “Among them who are born of women *there is none greater than John the Baptist*.”¹²³

Others make the suggestion (forced enough, clearly “that the apostles then served the turn of baptism when in their little ship, were sprinkled and covered with the waves: that Peter himself also was immersed enough when he walked on the sea.”¹²⁴ It is, however, as I think, one thing to be sprinkled or intercepted by the violence of the sea; another thing to be baptized in obedience to the discipline of religion. But that little ship did present a figure of the Church, in that she is disquieted

¹¹⁷John iii. 5, not fully given.

¹¹⁸See Gal. iii. 27.

¹¹⁹See Eph. iv. 5.

¹²⁰“Volenti,” which Oehler notes as a suggestion of Fr. Junius, is adopted here in preference to Oehler's “nolenti.”

¹²¹John xiii. 9, 10.

¹²²Exerta. Comp. c. xviii. *sub init.*; *ad Ux.* ii. c. i. *sub fin.*

¹²³Matt. xi. 11, ἐγγύερται omitted.

¹²⁴Matt. viii. 24; xiv. 28, 29. [Our author seems to allow that sprinkling is baptism, but not Christian baptism: a very curious passage. Compare the foot-washing, John xiii. 8.]

“in the sea,” that is, in the world,¹²⁵ “by the waves,” that is, by persecutions and temptations; the Lord, through patience, sleeping as it were, until, roused in their last extremities by the prayers of the saints, He checks the world,¹²⁶ and restores tranquillity to His own.

Now, whether they were baptized in any manner whatever, or whether they continued unbathed¹²⁷ to the end—so that even that saying of the Lord touching the “one bath”¹²⁸ does, under the person of Peter, merely regard *us*—still, to determine concerning the salvation of the apostles is audacious enough, because on *them* the prerogative even of first choice,¹²⁹ and thereafter of undivided intimacy, might be able to confer the compendious grace of baptism, seeing they (I think) followed Him who was wont to promise salvation to every believer. “Thy faith,” He would say, “hath saved thee;”¹³⁰ and, “Thy sins shall be remitted thee,”¹³¹ on thy believing, of course, albeit thou be not *yet* baptized. If that¹³² was wanting to the apostles, I know not in the faith of what things it was, that, roused by one word of the Lord, *one* left the toll-booth behind for ever;¹³³ *another* deserted father and ship, and the craft by which he gained his living;¹³⁴ *a third*, who disdained his father’s obsequies,¹³⁵ fulfilled, before he heard it, that highest precept of the Lord, “He who prefers father or mother to me, is not worthy of me.”¹³⁶

Another Objection: Abraham Pleased God Without Being Baptized. Answer Thereto. Old Things Must Give Place to New, and Baptism is Now a Law.

Chapter XIII.—Another Objection: Abraham Pleased God Without Being Baptized. Answer Thereto. Old Things Must Give Place to New, and Baptism is Now a Law.

Here, then, those miscreants¹³⁷ provoke questions. And so they say, “Baptism is not necessary for them to whom faith is sufficient; for withal, Abraham pleased God by a sacrament of no water, but of faith.” But in all cases it is the *later* things which have a conclusive force, and the *subsequent* which prevail over the antecedent. Grant that, in days gone by, there was salvation by means of bare faith, before the passion and resurrection of the Lord. But now that faith has been enlarged, and is become a faith which believes in His nativity, passion, and resurrection, there has been an amplification added to the sacrament,¹³⁸ viz., the sealing act of baptism; the clothing, in some sense, of the faith which before was bare, and which cannot exist now without its proper law. For the *law* of baptizing has been *imposed*, and the formula prescribed: “Go,” He saith, “teach the nations, baptizing them into the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.”¹³⁹ The comparison with this law of that definition, “Unless a man have been reborn of water and Spirit,

¹²⁵Sæculo.

¹²⁶Sæculum.

¹²⁷Illoti.

¹²⁸Lavacrum. [John xiii. 9, 10, as above.]

¹²⁹i.e. of being the first to be chosen.

¹³⁰Luke xviii. 42; Mark x. 52.

¹³¹“Remittuntur” is Oehler’s reading; “remittuntur” others read; but the Greek is in perfect tense. See Mark ii. 5.

¹³²i.e. faith, or perhaps the “compendious grace of baptism.”

¹³³Matt. ix. 9.

¹³⁴Matt. iv. 21, 22.

¹³⁵Luke ix. 59, 60; but it is not said there that the man *did* it.

¹³⁶Matt. x. 37.

¹³⁷i.e. probably the Cainites. See c. ii.

¹³⁸i.e. the sacrament, or obligation of faith. See beginning of chapter.

¹³⁹Matt. xxviii. 19: “all” omitted.

he shall not enter into the kingdom of the heavens,"¹⁴⁰ has tied faith to the necessity of baptism. Accordingly, all thereafter¹⁴¹ *who became* believers used to be baptized. Then it was, too,¹⁴² that Paul, when he believed, was baptized; and this is the meaning of the precept which the Lord had given him when smitten with the plague of loss of sight, saying, "Arise, and enter Damascus; there shall be demonstrated to thee what thou oughtest to do," to wit—be baptized, which was the only thing lacking to him. That point excepted, he had sufficiently *learnt and believed* "the Nazarene" to be "the Lord, the Son of God."¹⁴³

Of Paul's Assertion, that He Had Not Been Sent to Baptize.

Chapter XIV.—Of Paul's Assertion, that He Had Not Been Sent to Baptize.

But they roll back *an objection* from *that* apostle himself, in that he said, "For Christ sent me not to baptize;"¹⁴⁴ as if by this argument baptism were done away! For *if so*, why did he baptize Gaius, and Crispus, and the house of Stephanas?¹⁴⁵ However, even if Christ had not sent *him* to baptize, yet He had given *other* apostles the precept to baptize. But these words were written to the Corinthians in regard of the circumstances of that particular time; seeing that schisms and dissensions were agitated among them, while one attributes *everything* to Paul, another to Apollos.¹⁴⁶ For which reason the "peace-making"¹⁴⁷ apostle, for fear he should seem to claim all *gifts* for himself, says that he had been sent "not to baptize, but to preach." For preaching is the prior thing, baptizing the posterior. Therefore the preaching came *first*: but I think baptizing withal was *lawful* to him to whom preaching was.

Unity of Baptism. Remarks on Heretical And Jewish Baptism.

Chapter XV.—Unity of Baptism. Remarks on Heretical And Jewish Baptism.

I know not whether any further point is mooted to bring baptism into controversy. Permit me to call to mind what I have omitted above, lest I seem to break off the train of impending thoughts in the middle. There is to us one, and but one, baptism; as well according to the Lord's gospel¹⁴⁸ as according to the apostle's letters,¹⁴⁹ inasmuch as *he says*, "One God, and one baptism, and one church in the heavens."¹⁵⁰ But it must be admitted that the question, "What rules are to be observed with regard to heretics?" is worthy of being treated. For it is to *us*¹⁵¹ that that assertion¹⁵² refers. Heretics, however, have no fellowship in our discipline, whom the mere fact of their excommunication¹⁵³ testifies to be outsiders. I am not bound to recognize in *them* a thing which is enjoined on *me*, because they and we have not the same God, nor one—that is, *the same*—Christ.

¹⁴⁰John ii. 5: "shall not" for "cannot;" "kingdom of the heavens"—an expression only occurring in Matthew—for "kingdom of God."

¹⁴¹i.e. from the time when the Lord gave the "law."

¹⁴²i.e. not till *after* the "law" had been made.

¹⁴³See Acts ix. 1–31.

¹⁴⁴1 Cor. i. 17.

¹⁴⁵1 Cor. i. 14, 16.

¹⁴⁶1 Cor. i. 11, 12; iii. 3, 4.

¹⁴⁷Matt. v. 9; referred to in *de Patien.* c. ii.

¹⁴⁸Oehler refers us to c. xii. above, "He who hath once bathed."

¹⁴⁹i.e. the Epistle to the Ephesians especially.

¹⁵⁰Eph. iv. 4, 5, 6, but very inexactly quoted.

¹⁵¹i.e. us Christians; of "Catholics," as Oehler explains it.

¹⁵²i.e. touching the "one baptism."

¹⁵³Ademptio communicationis. [See Bunsen, *Hippol.* III. p. 114, Canon 46.]

And therefore their baptism is not one *with ours* either, because it is not *the same*; a baptism which, since they have it not duly, doubtless they have *not at all*; nor is that capable of being *counted* which is not *had*.¹⁵⁴ Thus they cannot *receive* it either, because they *have it not*. But this point has already received a fuller discussion from us in Greek. We enter, then, the font¹⁵⁵ *once*: *once* are sins washed away, because they ought never to be repeated. But the Jewish Israel bathes daily,¹⁵⁶ because he is daily being defiled: and, for fear that *defilement* should be practised among *us* also, therefore was the definition touching the one bathing¹⁵⁷ made. Happy water, which *once* washes away; which does not mock sinners (with vain hopes); which does not, by being infected with the repetition of impurities, again defile them whom it has washed!

Of the Second Baptism—With Blood.

Chapter XVI.—Of the Second Baptism—With Blood.

We *have* indeed, likewise, a *second* font,¹⁵⁸ (itself withal *one with the former*;) of *blood*, to wit; concerning which the Lord said, “I have to be baptized with a baptism,”¹⁵⁹ when He had been baptized already. For He had come “by means of water and blood,”¹⁶⁰ just as John has written; that He might be baptized by the water, glorified by the blood; to make *us*, in like manner, *called* by *water*, *chosen*¹⁶¹ by *blood*. These two baptisms He sent out from the wound in His pierced side,¹⁶² in order that they who believed in His blood might be bathed with the water; they who had been bathed in the water might likewise drink the blood.¹⁶³ This is the baptism which both stands in lieu of the fontal bathing¹⁶⁴ when that has not been received, and restores it when lost.

Of the Power of Conferring Baptism.

Chapter XVII.—Of the Power of Conferring Baptism.

For concluding our brief subject,¹⁶⁵ it remains to put you in mind also of the due observance of giving and receiving baptism. Of giving it, the chief priest¹⁶⁶ (who is the bishop) has the right: in the next place, the presbyters and deacons, yet not without the bishop’s authority, on account of the honour of the Church, which being preserved, peace is preserved. Beside these, even laymen have the right; for what is equally received can be equally given. Unless bishops, or priests, or deacons, be on the spot, *other* disciples are called *i.e. to the work*. The word of the Lord ought not to be hidden by any: in like manner, too, baptism, which is equally God’s property,¹⁶⁷ can be administered by all. But how much more is the rule¹⁶⁸ of reverence and modesty incumbent on laymen—seeing that

¹⁵⁴Comp. Eccles. i. 15.

¹⁵⁵Lavacrum.

¹⁵⁶Compare *de Orat.* c. xiv.

¹⁵⁷In John xiii. 10, and Eph. iv. 5.

¹⁵⁸Lavacrum. [See Aquinas, *Quæst.* lxvi. 11.]

¹⁵⁹Luke xii. 50, not given in full.

¹⁶⁰John v. 6.

¹⁶¹Matt. xx. 16; Rev. xvii. 14.

¹⁶²John xix. 34. See c. ix. *ad fin.*

¹⁶³See John vi. 53, etc.

¹⁶⁴Lavacrum. [The three baptisms: *fluminis, flaminis, sanguinis*.]

¹⁶⁵Materiolam.

¹⁶⁶Summus sacerdos. Compare *de Orat.* xxviii., “nos... veri sacerdotes,” etc.: and *de Ex. Cast.* c. vii., “nonne et laici sacerdotes sumus?”

¹⁶⁷Census.

¹⁶⁸Disciplina.

these *powers*¹⁶⁹ belong to their superiors—lest they assume to themselves the *specific*¹⁷⁰ function of the bishop! Emulation of the episcopal office is the mother of schisms. The most holy apostle has said, that “all things are *lawful*, but not all *expedient*.”¹⁷¹ Let it suffice assuredly, in cases of *necessity*, to avail yourself (of that rule¹⁷², if at any time circumstance either of place, or of time, or of person compels you (so to do); for *then* the steadfast courage of the succourer, when the situation of the endangered one is urgent, is exceptionally admissible; inasmuch as he will be guilty of a human creature’s loss if he shall refrain from bestowing what he had free liberty to bestow. But the woman of pertness,¹⁷³ who has usurped the power to teach, will of course not give birth for herself likewise to a right of baptizing, unless some new beast shall arise¹⁷⁴ like the former; so that, just as the one abolished baptism,¹⁷⁵ so some other should in her own right confer it! But if the writings which wrongly go under Paul’s name, claim Thecla’s example as a licence for women’s teaching and baptizing, let them know that, in Asia, the presbyter who composed that writing,¹⁷⁶ as if he were augmenting Paul’s fame from his own store, after being convicted, and confessing that he had done it from love of Paul, was removed¹⁷⁷ from his office. For how credible would it seem, that he who has not permitted a *woman*¹⁷⁸ even to *learn* with over-boldness, should give a *female*¹⁷⁹ the power of *teaching* and of *baptizing*! “Let them be silent,” he says, “and at home consult their own husbands.”¹⁸⁰

Of the Persons to Whom, and the Time When, Baptism is to Be Administered.

Chapter XVIII.—Of the Persons to Whom, and the Time When, Baptism is to Be Administered.

But they whose office it is, know that baptism is not rashly to be administered. “Give to every one who beggeth thee,”¹⁸¹ has a reference of its own, appertaining especially to almsgiving. On the contrary, this *precept* is rather to be looked at carefully: “Give not the holy thing to the dogs, nor cast your pearls before swine;”¹⁸² and, “Lay not hands easily on *any*; share not other men’s sins.”¹⁸³ If Philip so “easily” baptized the chamberlain, let us reflect that a manifest and conspicuous¹⁸⁴ evidence that the Lord deemed him worthy had been interposed.¹⁸⁵ The Spirit had enjoined Philip to proceed to that road: the eunuch himself, too, was not found idle, nor as one who was suddenly seized with an eager desire to be baptized; but, after going up to the temple for prayer’s sake, being intently engaged on the divine Scripture, was thus suitably discovered—to whom God had,

¹⁶⁹i.e. the powers of administering baptism and “sowing the word.” [i.e. “The Keys.” *Scorpiace*, p. 643.]

¹⁷⁰Dicatum.

¹⁷¹1 Cor. x. 23, where *μοι* in the received text seems interpolated.

¹⁷²Or, as Oehler explains it, of your power of baptizing, etc.

¹⁷³Quintilla. See c. i.

¹⁷⁴Evenerit. Perhaps Tertullian means literally—though that sense of the word is very rare—“shall issue out of her,” alluding to his “pariet” above.

¹⁷⁵See c. i. *ad fin*.

¹⁷⁶The allusion is to a spurious work entitled *Acta Pauli et Theclæ*. [Of which afterwards. But see Jones, *on the Canon*, II. p. 353, and Lardner, *Credibility*, II. p. 305.]

¹⁷⁷Decessisse.

¹⁷⁸Mulieri.

¹⁷⁹Fœminæ.

¹⁸⁰1 Cor. xiv. 34, 35.

¹⁸¹Luke vi. 30. [See note 4, p. 676.]

¹⁸²Matt. vii. 6.

¹⁸³1 Tim. v. 22; *μηδεν* omitted, *ταχέως* rendered by “facile,” and *μηδὲ* by “ne.”

¹⁸⁴“Exertam,” as in c. xii.: “probatio exerta,” “a conspicuous proof.”

¹⁸⁵Comp. Acts viii. 26–40.

unasked, sent an apostle, which one, again, the Spirit bade adjoin himself to the chamberlain's chariot. The Scripture which *he was reading*¹⁸⁶ falls in opportunely with his faith: *Philip*, being requested, is taken to sit beside him; the Lord is pointed out; faith lingers not; water needs no waiting for; the work is completed, and the apostle snatched away. "But Paul too was, in fact, 'speedily' baptized:" for Simon,¹⁸⁷ his host, speedily recognized him to be "an appointed vessel of election." God's approbation sends sure premonitory tokens before it; every "petition"¹⁸⁸ may both deceive and be deceived. And so, according to the circumstances and disposition, and even age, of each individual, the delay of baptism is preferable; principally, however, in the case of little children. For why is it necessary—if (baptism itself) is not so necessary¹⁸⁹—that the sponsors likewise should be thrust into danger? Who both themselves, by reason of mortality, may fail to fulfil their promises, and may be disappointed by the development of an evil disposition, *in those for whom they stood*? The Lord does indeed say, "Forbid them not to come unto me."¹⁹⁰ Let them "come," then, while they are growing up; let them "come" while they are learning, while they are learning whither to come;¹⁹¹ let them become Christians¹⁹² when they have become able to know Christ. Why does the innocent period of life hasten to the "remission of sins?" More caution will be exercised in worldly¹⁹³ matters: so that one who is *not* trusted with earthly substance *is* trusted with divine! Let them know how to "ask" for salvation, that you may seem (at least) to have given "to him that asketh."¹⁹⁴ For no less cause must the unwedded also be deferred—in whom *the ground of temptation* is prepared, alike in such as *never were wedded*¹⁹⁵ by means of their maturity, and in the *widowed* by means of their freedom—until they either marry, or else be more fully strengthened for continence. If any understand the weighty import of baptism, they will fear its reception more than its delay: sound faith is secure of salvation.

Of the Times Most Suitable for Baptism.

Chapter XIX.—Of the Times Most Suitable for Baptism.

The Passover affords a more *than usually* solemn day for baptism; when, withal, the Lord's passion, in which we are baptized, was completed. Nor will it be incongruous to interpret figuratively *the fact* that, when the Lord was about to celebrate the last Passover, He said to the disciples who were sent to make preparation, "Ye will meet a man bearing water."¹⁹⁶ He points out the place for celebrating the Passover by the sign of *water*. After that, Pentecost is a most joyous space¹⁹⁷ for

¹⁸⁶Acts viii. 28, 30, 32, 33, and Isa. liii. 7, 8, especially in LXX. The quotation, as given in Acts, agrees nearly *verbatim* with the Cod. Alex. there.

¹⁸⁷Tertullian seems to have confused the "Judas" with whom Saul stayed (Acts ix. 11) with the "Simon" with whom St. Peter stayed (Acts ix. 43); and it was Ananias, not Judas, to whom he was pointed out as "an appointed vessel," and by whom he was baptized. [So above, he seems to have confounded Philip, the deacon, with Philip the apostle.]

¹⁸⁸See note 24, [where Luke vi. 30 is shown to be abused].

¹⁸⁹Tertullian has already allowed (in c. xvi) that baptism is not *indispensably* necessary to salvation.

¹⁹⁰Matt. xix. 14; Mark x. 14; Luke xviii. 16.

¹⁹¹Or, "whither they are coming."

¹⁹²i.e. in baptism.

¹⁹³Sæcularibus.

¹⁹⁴See beginning of chapter, [where Luke vi. 30, is shown to be abused].

¹⁹⁵Virginibus; but he is speaking about men as well as women. Comp. *de Orat.* c. xxii. [I need not point out the bearings of the above chapter, nor do I desire to interpose any comments. The Editor's interpolations, where purely gratuitous, I have even stricken out, though I agree with them. See that work of genius, the *Liberty of Prophesying*, by Jer. Taylor, sect. xviii. and its candid admissions.]

¹⁹⁶Mark xiv. 13; Luke xxii. 10, "a small earthen pitcher of water."

¹⁹⁷[He means the whole fifty days from the Paschal Feast till Pentecost, including the latter. Bunsen *Hippol.* III. 18.]

conferring baptisms;¹⁹⁸ wherein, too, the resurrection of the Lord was repeatedly proved¹⁹⁹ among the disciples, and the hope of the advent of the Lord indirectly pointed to, in that, at that time, when He had been received back into the heavens, the angels²⁰⁰ told the apostles that “He would so come, as He had withal ascended into the heavens;”²⁰¹ at Pentecost, of course. But, moreover, when Jeremiah says, “And I will gather them together from the extremities of the land in the feast-day,” he signifies the day of the Passover and of Pentecost, which is properly a “feast-day.”²⁰² However, *every day* is the Lord’s; every hour, every time, is apt for baptism: if there is a difference in the *solemnity*, distinction there is none in the *grace*.

Of Preparation For, and Conduct After, the Reception of Baptism.

Chapter XX.—Of Preparation For, and Conduct After, the Reception of Baptism.

They who are about to enter baptism ought to pray with repeated prayers, fasts, and bendings of the knee, and vigils all the night through, and with the confession of all bygone sins, that they may express *the meaning* even of the baptism of John: “They were baptized,” saith (the Scripture), “confessing their own sins.”²⁰³ To us it is matter for thankfulness if we do *now* publicly confess our iniquities or our turpitudes:²⁰⁴ for we do at the same time both make satisfaction²⁰⁵ for our former sins, by mortification of our flesh and spirit, and lay beforehand the foundation of defences against the temptations which will closely follow. “Watch and pray,” saith (the Lord), “lest ye fall into temptation.”²⁰⁶ And the reason, I believe, why they *were* tempted was, that they fell asleep; so that they deserted the Lord when apprehended, and he who continued to stand by Him, and used the sword, even denied Him thrice: for withal the word had gone before, that “no one *untempted* should attain the celestial kingdoms.”²⁰⁷ The Lord Himself forthwith after *baptism*²⁰⁸ temptations surrounded, when in forty days He had kept fast. “Then,” some one will say, “it becomes *us*, too, rather to fast *after* baptism.”²⁰⁹ Well, and who forbids you, unless it be the necessity for joy, and the thanksgiving for salvation? But so far as I, with my poor powers, understand, the Lord figuratively retorted upon Israel the reproach *they had cast on the Lord*.²¹⁰ For the people, after crossing the sea, and being carried about in the desert during forty years, although they were there nourished with divine supplies, nevertheless were more mindful of their belly and their gullet than of God. Thereupon the Lord, driven apart into desert places after baptism,²¹¹ showed, by maintaining a fast

¹⁹⁸Lavacris.

¹⁹⁹Frequentata, i.e. by His frequent appearance. See Acts i. 3, δι’ ἡμερῶν τεσσαράκοντα ὁπτανόμενος αὐτοῖς.

²⁰⁰Comp. Acts i. 10 and Luke ix. 30: in each place St. Luke says, ἄνδρες δύο: as also in xxiv. 4 of his Gospel.

²⁰¹Acts i. 10, 11; but it is οὐρανόν throughout in the Greek.

²⁰²Jer. xxxi. 8, xxxviii. 8 in LXX., where ἐν ἑορτῇ φασέκ is found, which is not in the English version.

²⁰³Matt. iii. 6. [See the collection of Dr. Bunsen for the whole primitive discipline to which Tertullian has reference, *Hippol.* Vol. III. pp. 5–23, and 29.]

²⁰⁴Perhaps Tertullian is referring to Prov. xxviii. 13. If we confess *now*, we shall be forgiven, and not put to shame at the judgment day.

²⁰⁵See *de Orat.* c. xxiii. *ad fin.*, and the note there.

²⁰⁶Matt. xxvi. 41.

²⁰⁷What passage is referred to is doubtful. The editors point us to Luke xxii. 28, 29; but the reference is unsatisfactory.

²⁰⁸Lavacro.

²⁰⁹Lavacro. Compare the beginning of the chapter.

²¹⁰Viz. by their murmuring for bread (see Ex. xvi. 3, 7); and again—nearly forty years after—in another place. See Num. xxi. 5.

²¹¹Aquam: just as St. Paul says the Israelites had been “baptized” (or “baptized themselves”) “into Moses in the cloud and in the sea.” 1 Cor. x. 2.

of forty days, that the man of God lives “not by bread alone,” but “by the word of God;”²¹² and that temptations incident to fulness or immoderation of appetite are shattered by abstinence. Therefore, blessed *ones*, whom the grace of God awaits, when you ascend from that most sacred font²¹³ of your new birth, and spread your hands²¹⁴ for the first time in the house of your mother,²¹⁵ together with your brethren, ask from the Father, ask from the Lord, that His own specialties of grace *and* distributions of gifts²¹⁶ may be supplied you. “Ask,” saith He, “and ye shall receive.”²¹⁷ Well, you *have* asked, and have received; you *have* knocked, and it has been opened to you. Only, I pray that, when you are asking, you be mindful likewise of Tertullian the sinner.²¹⁸

Elucidation.

The argument (p. 673, note 6,) is conclusive, but not clear. The disciples of John must have been baptized by him, (Luke vii. 29–30) and “all the people,” must have included those whom Jesus called. But, this was not Christ’s baptism: See Acts xix. 2, 5. Compare note 8, p. 673. And see the American Editor’s “Apollon.”

²¹²Matt. iv. 1–4.

²¹³Lavacro.

²¹⁴In prayer: comp. *de Orat.* c. xiv.

²¹⁵i.e. the Church: comp. *de Orat.* c. 2.

²¹⁶1 Cor. xii. 4–12.

²¹⁷Matt. vii. 7; Luke xi. 9; αἰτεῖτε, καὶ δοθήσεται, ὑμῖν in both places.

²¹⁸[The translator, though so learned and helpful, too often encumbers the text with superfluous interpolations. As many of these, while making the reading difficult, add nothing to the sense yet destroy the terse, crabbed force of the original, I have occasionally restored the spirit of a sentence, by removing them.]